

Digital Literacy

Project Report

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Introduction

This is a Digital Literacy project where I have taken on the role of a Student Digital Ambassador in a real-world whose experiences highlight a critical gap that exists among students today — the difference between being digitally active and being digitally aware.

Through five tasks, this project explores key areas of digital literacy: creating awareness resources, building a responsible online presence, practising safe and effective collaboration, communicating professionally in digital spaces, and studying a case and its prevention guide. Each task required not just technical participation but genuine reflection on how digital tools affect identity, learning, communication, and security.

The goal of this project is to move beyond tool usage and develop the habits, awareness, and responsibility that define true digital literacy.

Task 1: Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

The infographic was created using Canva, an online design tool that allows users to produce professional-quality visuals with ease. The design focuses on key aspects of digital literacy, including understanding digital tools, practicing safe internet habits, and understanding email etiquettes. Each section uses concise text, icons, and color-coded segments to help viewers quickly grasp the main ideas. This layout was chosen to make the infographic suitable for brochures and digital displays, ensuring that the information is easy to read on pamphlets of various sizes. One interesting aspect of the process was experimenting with visual hierarchy—deciding how to balance text and imagery so that the design remained engaging without becoming cluttered. It was also challenging to condense complex topics into short, impactful statements while keeping the overall design visually appealing and informative.

Task 2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

I created and set up accounts on three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Stack Overflow.

GitHub is a version control and code hosting platform used by developers worldwide. I created a profile README repository containing my name, branch, year, and a brief statement about what I hope to learn. I plan to use GitHub over the next four years to store projects, contribute to open-source repositories, and demonstrate my practical coding skills to future employers.

LinkedIn is a professional networking platform. I filled in my Education section with my current degree, institution, and expected graduation year. Over time, I plan to add internships, certifications, and projects, and use it to connect with professionals and explore career opportunities.

Stack Overflow is a community platform for programmers to ask and answer technical questions. I set up my profile and plan to use it as a learning resource throughout my degree, eventually contributing answers as my knowledge grows.

Task 3: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

I used HackerRank as my primary platform to practise coding and build problem-solving skills. HackerRank is an online coding platform that offers challenges across domains such as Python, data structures, algorithms, and mathematics, making it highly relevant for engineering students looking to strengthen their programming foundation.

I began by setting up my HackerRank profile and started solving challenges. The first problem I solved was the classic "Solve Me First" warm-up, which involved writing a function to compute the sum of two integers. While simple, it helped me understand how HackerRank structures its problems — with function descriptions, input constraints, and expected outputs — which is similar to how real coding interviews are conducted.

I plan to continue using HackerRank throughout my degree to progressively tackle harder challenges, earn skill certifications, and prepare for technical placement interviews in my final year.

Task 4: Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Checklist:

Do's

- Keep your professional profiles accurate and up to date.
 - Think before you post.
 - Use privacy settings to control who can view your personal posts and information.
 - Engage positively by participating in academic discussions.
 - Credit original creators when sharing someone else's work.
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Don'ts

- Do not share personal information publicly.
 - Do not post offensive, discriminatory, or emotionally charged content.
 - Do not connect with unknown accounts offering jobs, prizes, or opportunities without verifying them first.
 - Do not mix your professional and personal tone.
 - Do not ignore suspicious activity on your accounts.
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Poor Digital Communication Situation:

A situation where poor digital communication caused a real problem involves a college student who applied for a campus hackathon. After being shortlisted, the organiser sent a formal email asking for confirmation of participation by a specific date. The student replied with "yeah I'm in, will come." The student arrived on the day expecting to participate and was turned away because their seat had been given to someone else.

What could have been done differently is simple, a one-line professional reply such as "Dear Sir, I confirm my participation. Thank you for the opportunity" would have avoided the situation entirely.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

I researched UPI and online payment fraud as my chosen cybercrime type. I wrote a case study emphasising a real published. I also created a Stay Safe Online prevention checklist with nine actionable tips specifically relevant to college students in India, including two tips focused on UPI and financial safety, along with the National Cyber Crime Helpline number and the reporting portal.

What surprised me most during my research was the scale of the problem. According to Ministry of Finance data presented in the Lok Sabha, UPI fraud cases increased by 85% in just one.

The one habit I will personally change is to always verify the UPI collect request type before entering my PIN. I now understand that entering a PIN confirms a payment going out, not coming in and that single awareness could prevent a significant financial loss.

Conclusion

This project helped me move beyond surface-level digital tool usage and develop a more responsible and aware approach to my online presence. Through five tasks, I created an awareness infographic using Canva, built professional profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Stack Overflow, practised coding on HackerRank, collaborated on a Google Form, wrote formal emails, researched real cybercrime, and made checklists. The most important takeaway from this project is that digital literacy is not a one-time lesson but a continuous habit of questioning, verifying, and reflecting on every digital action I take.

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